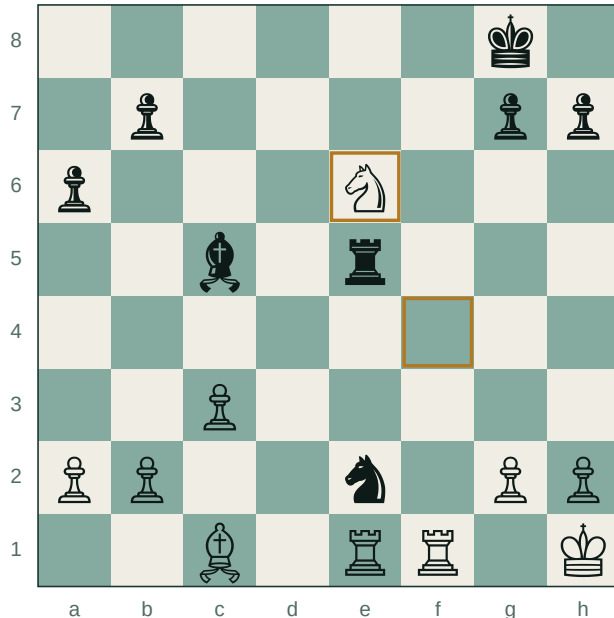


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 26

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 26.Nxe6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...Ng3+ 27. hxg3 Rh5#

26...Ng3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From g3 it attacks king on h1 and rook on f1. Recorded reply: **27.hxg3**.

27...Rh5# Mate: rook on h5 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h5. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: knight on e6. Check for tactical protection.